Inglés I

Grammar:

Quantifiers

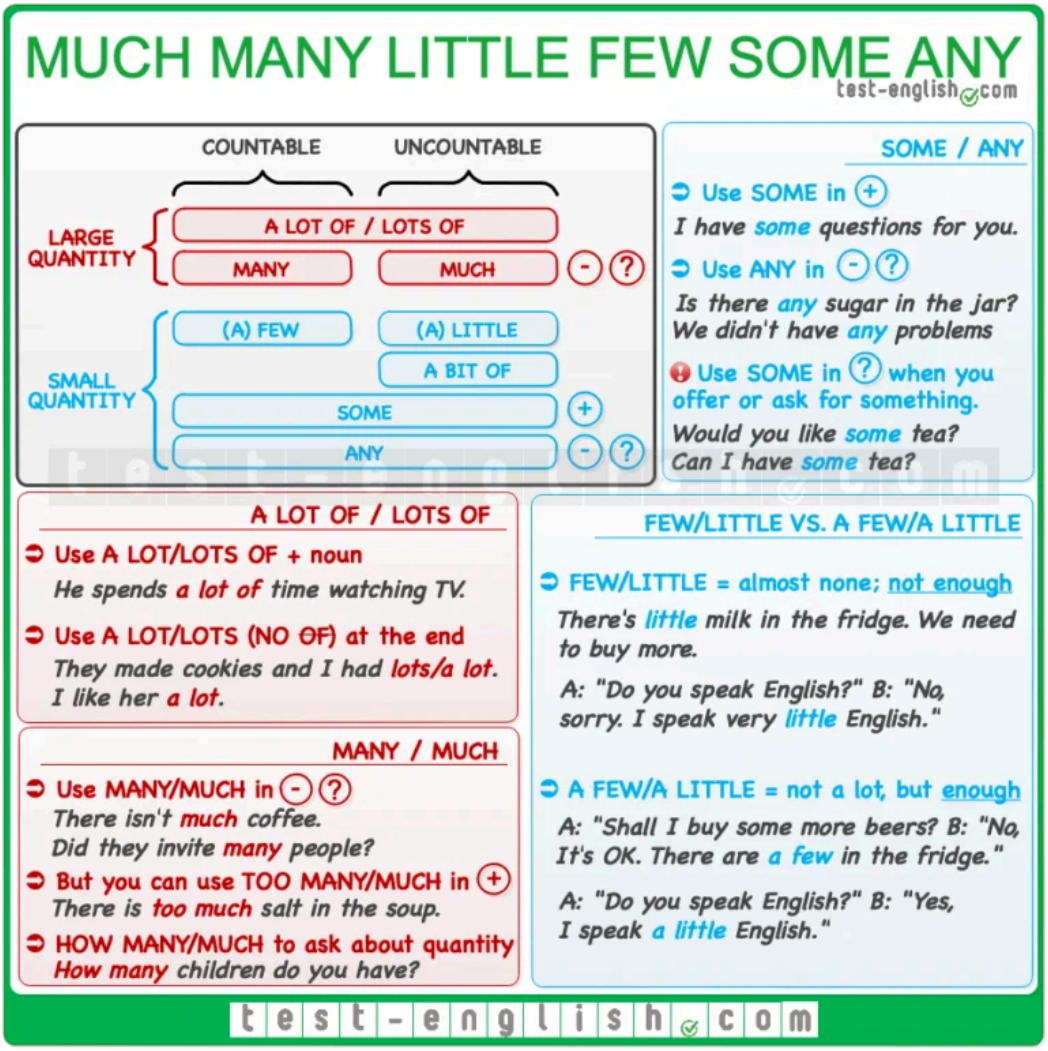
much, many, little, few, some, any

Quantifiers

A **quantifier** is a word or phrase used before a noun to show its amount or quantity.
A noun can be **countable** (a book, two horses, three people…) or **uncountable** (water, sugar, milk…). We use different quantifiers before these different types of nouns.

Some quantifiers are: **much, many, little, few, some, any**

Let's look at this chart:



Many/much

Many for countable, **much** for uncountable in (?) (-)

We use **many** before **plural** (countable) nouns and **much** before **uncountable** nouns. We use them in **negative** sentences and **questions**. We don't normally use them in affirmative sentences.

> *There isn't **much coffee** in the jar.*
> *Were there **many people** in the party?*

Too much/too many

🔍 **Note** that we don't normally use **much**/**many** in affirmative sentences, but we can use **too much** and **too many** in affirmative sentences.

> *There's **too much salt** in the soup.*
> *You eat **too many biscuits**.*

How much/how many

We use **how many** and **how much** to ask about quantity.

> ***How many concerts** have you ever been to?*
> ***How much coffee** have you had today?*

A lot of/lots of

Before both countable and uncountable

We use **a lot of** or **lots of** (more informal) before both **plural** (countable) and **uncountable** nouns. We normally use them in positive sentences.

> *She spends **a lot of time** watching TV.*
> *We had **lots of good** moments together.*

Of before noun but NOT at the end of sentence

We must always use **a lot of** or **lots of** including **of** before a noun. However, we can use the expressions **a lot** or **lots** (without **of**) at the end of a sentence.

> *'How many beers did you have?' 'I don't know; I had **lots/a lot**.'*
> *I like her **a lot**.*

(A) few/(a) little/a bit of

Few for countable; **little** for uncountable

We use **(a) few** before **plural** (countable) nouns and **(a) little** or **a bit of** (more informal) before **uncountable** nouns.

> *I have to do **a few things** this afternoon.*
> *He always gets good results with very **little effort**.*
> *Can you put **a bit of sugar** in the tea?*

Few or **a few**? **little** or **a little**?

A few means ‘some but not many; enough’, and **a little** means ‘some but not much; enough’.

Few/little mean ‘almost none; not enough’.

Normally, the difference between **a few/little** (WITH **a**) and **few/little** (WITHOUT **a**) is that **a few/little** is positive in meaning, and **few/little** is negative. Compare:

> *There’s **little milk** in the fridge; we have to buy more.* (Not enough; we need more)
> *‘Shall I buy some beers?’ ‘No, it’s OK, there are **a few** in the fridge.’* (=Enough; we don’t need more)
> *‘Do you speak English?’ ‘**No**, I speak very **little English**.’* (=Negative)
> *‘Do you speak English?’ ‘**Yes**, I speak **a little English**.*’ (=Positive)

Some/any

Some in (+); **any** in (?) (-)

We use **some** in **affirmative** sentences and **any** in **negative** sentences and **questions**.

> *Is there **any sugar** in the cupboard?*
> *Have you got **any new friends**?*
> *I have **some questions** to ask you.*

With both countable (plural) and uncountable

Both **some** and **any** can be used before **countable and uncountable** nouns. But if we use them before a countable noun, the noun must be in the **plural** form.

> *Is there any student in the classroom?* ✖
> *Are there any students in the classroom?* ✔

Some for offers and requests

We use **some** (NOT **any**) in interrogative sentences when we are offering or requesting (=asking for) something.

> *Would you like some help?*
> *Can I have some tea, please?*

Let's practise:
https://test-english.com/grammar-points/a2/much-many-little-few-some-any/
https://test-english.com/grammar-points/a2/much-many-little-few-some-any/3/
https://test-english.com/grammar-points/a2/much-many-little-few-some-any/5/

https://www.baamboozle.com/classic/650545